



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting June 15th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JcXfsed-UFg
Publication Date	2020-06-15T17:32:01Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Report: Delaware County Commissioners

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners was called to order by the presiding officer. Discussions throughout the meeting centered on county infrastructure, code updates, operational agreements, and community policing.
- **Attendance:** Specific individual roll call attendance rosters were not explicitly read aloud into the transcript record, though various commissioners, chief deputies, and department heads participated actively. Presiding officers and board members (including references to Commissioner King and other commissioners) led the proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - [00:03:22](#) The board reviewed and approved the prior meeting minutes from June 1, 2020.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (roll call requested/conducted per transcript procedural cue).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:27 Maximum Tax Rate Adoption / Bridge Rehab Funding**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County administration / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed setting the maximum tax rate. It was clarified that adoption only sets the maximum rate ceiling, while the actual rate is set by the council during budget hearings. Commissioners noted that funds are needed for the rehabilitation and maintenance of approximately 30 timber bridges remaining out in the county. A suggestion was made to develop a specific line item for bridge rehab purposes.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:04:02 Court and Juvenile Services Financial Claims / Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy / Court services.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of various financial claims and service contracts: \$1,105 for sports/recreation; another order; \$5,730 for juvenile court and all five circuit courts; and \$4,092 to purchase a specified tool/item.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:07:35 Stormwater Easement Agreement (Town of Daleville)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Town of Daleville is undertaking a stormwater improvement project and requested a narrow strip of land as an easement from the county.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:10:17 Dispatch Software Upgrade Service Agreement (E911 / Emergitech)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dispatch/Emergency services department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The department requested a replacement software agreement to update current dispatching systems (after the previous vendors split partnerships). The new software guides dispatchers through medical call symptom questions and protocols. It also enables the certification of police and fire dispatchers to the same standards as emergency medical dispatchers. The cost is a maximum of approximately \$23,000, funded out of state monies (Account 466).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:12:32 Surplus Vehicle Donation Agreement**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Deputy Jeff Stanley, Sheriff's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Deputy Stanley reported that Chief James Turner of the police department contacted the office regarding a surplus 2010 Dodge Charger currently sitting with a newer motor and front-end issues. The police department is willing to cover the repair costs to make it operational if the county donates the vehicle to local government use.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:20:12 Emergency Declaration Extension (Resolution 2020-12)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed an emergency declaration following the Governor's Phase 4 "Back on Track" plan (incorporating Executive Orders 20-30 and 31 extending the health emergency). The declaration outlines rules for public entry into county buildings, requiring social distancing at all times, encouraging masks for the public and employees, maintaining precautions for high-risk individuals, and permitting social gatherings up to 250 people in line with state guidelines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:22:07 Jail Construction Energy Incentive Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County administration / construction project manager.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed negotiating an energy incentive agreement with the jail construction contractor regarding energy-efficient electrical systems and gas installations. Electrical and utility providers offer cash rebates and incentives (up to \$150,000 from one provider and up to \$100,000 from another). The contractor will compile and submit the specific serial numbers/paperwork, and the resulting rebates will be split: 35% for the contractor and 65% returned to the county (estimated around \$100,000 back to County General).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:25:09 Ordinance No. 2020-07: Building Code Amendment & Adoption by Reference**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Building department / County administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of an ordinance amending Title 4, Chapter 1 of the Delaware County Code regarding building code regulations and adoption by reference. Staff explained that this update allows the county to automatically stay up to date with state building codes and changes made by the State Fire and Building Safety Commission, preventing the need for individual amendments every time the state alters building codes. Specific code listings and major amendments will be posted on the county website.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced / Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **00:28:07 Resolution No. 2020-02: Transfer of County Properties to Nonprofits**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Regional Planning.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of transferring specific county-owned properties to nonprofit entities, including requests for the 1000 block of West 8th Street, 649 North Madison, and 1339 East Main Street. Properties were requested by groups including Muncie-Interim Regional Planning District, Frost Community Center, and Muncie Home Ownership and Revaluation. Adoption of this resolution initiates publication in the newspaper and sets a public hearing for the July 6 meeting.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **00:29:34 Departmental Claims Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Auditor / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of routine county claims totaling \$3,332,025.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:29:59 Cameron Grubbs**
 - **Key Concerns:** Addressed the board regarding community communication gaps and live-streaming technical issues. Asked what concrete plans the county and local law enforcement agencies have regarding community concerns following national protests (specifically referencing Minneapolis and incidents of police brutality), noting a desire for formal county statements against racism and police brutality. Questioned commissioner remarks and symbolism observed during meetings.
 - **00:32:00 Board & Law Enforcement Response (Chief Deputy Stanley, Commissioners)**
 - **Key Responses:** Chief Deputy Stanley and commissioners engaged in an extensive dialogue concerning police standards, standard operating procedures (SOPs), hiring challenges, candidate screening, background checks, and the use of the County Sheriff's open-door policy. Officials highlighted that the Sheriff's Office is actively reviewing its SOPs in partnership with an external professional firm (following discussions at the Indiana Sheriffs Association conference in Bloomington) and emphasized that local departments maintain high professional standards and community engagement.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Noted upcoming public hearings scheduled for the July 6 meeting regarding property transfers to nonprofits.
- **Adjournment:**
 - The meeting concluded following public forum exchanges and final administrative proceedings. *(Exact numerical time of adjournment was not formally verbalized on the transcript record).*

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